

Technical and Product Research Report: AI-Powered Legal Knowledge Workspace for the Indian Market

Section 1: Problem Validation and Indian Market Size

The legal sector in India is experiencing a structural transition driven by massive court backlogs, nationwide judicial digitization initiatives, and regulatory updates such as the Digital Personal Data Protection Act of 2023.¹ With over 50 million pending cases across different levels of the judiciary, enterprise legal departments and independent law firms face significant administrative challenges.¹ These challenges are compounded by the rapid accumulation of unstructured, unsearchable legal files, including court orders, First Information Reports (FIRs),

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.nt records, and scanned PDFs.

To address these backlogs, the Indian government has prioritized the digitization of court records. The scale of this transition is reflected in the volume of digitized court pages across state High Courts and District Courts:

Pages Digitized Across Indian Judicial Forums

Judicial Forum (State/Union Territory)	Total Pages Digitized in High Courts	Total Pages Digitized in District Courts
Allahabad	57,74,41,007	1,68,69,63,743
Delhi	23,46,18,073	10,48,83,922
Punjab & Haryana	29,46,04,020	62,82,06,241
Madhya Pradesh	24,62,88,505	66,68,95,995
Madras	20,76,93,848	13,16,62,142
Telangana	12,85,86,477	7,61,42,250
Rajasthan	13,44,36,567	3,50,10,815

Bombay	8,90,63,956	22,07,485
Kerala	8,17,95,531	1,71,13,720
Calcutta	5,95,17,135	0
Orissa	5,33,13,761	17,36,02,357
Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh	4,11,76,756	2,50,11,814
Andhra Pradesh	3,41,11,865	17,28,50,732
Jharkhand	3,01,84,408	96,24,854
Patna	2,40,49,339	2,39,56,123
Uttarakhand	2,41,91,236	1,33,14,115
Gauhati - Assam	2,97,53,593	15,58,31,203
Gauhati - Mizoram	12,31,287	20,97,820
Gauhati - Arunachal Pradesh	5,06,407	1,26,322
Chhattisgarh	24,26,800	1,91,84,603
Gujarat	16,98,629	11,64,409
Himachal Pradesh	79,15,775	11,81,757
Manipur	58,56,075	57,36,785
Meghalaya	11,56,596	38,20,961
Sikkim	11,73,135	54,15,378

Tripura	54,39,454	5,62,558
National Cumulative Total	2,36,96,50,903	4,00,89,15,374

This total of over 6.37 billion digitized pages highlights the immediate need for advanced document retrieval, semantic search, and processing systems capable of managing complex legal materials.³

The Indian legal services market reached a valuation of USD 27.95 Billion in 2025 and is projected to grow at a CAGR of 4.66% from 2026 to 2034, reaching USD 42.09 Billion.⁴

Alternative assessments place the immediate legal services segment at USD 2.49 Billion in 2025, with expectations to scale to USD 3.52 Billion by 2031 at a CAGR of 5.92%.⁵ While offline services account for 72.3% of the market due to the procedurally dense and relationship-driven nature of Indian litigation, online legal services represent the fastest-growing sector, expanding at a CAGR of 6.8%.⁴ This expansion is driven by India's 63 million MSMEs, which require accessible and cost-effective digital legal support for regulatory filings, contracts, and dispute management.⁴

Regional Legal Services Market Share in India (2025)

Geographic Region	Market Share (%)	Key Drivers and Characteristics
North India	31.6% ⁴	High concentration of regulatory bodies, national tribunals, the Supreme Court, and major law firm headquarters in New Delhi. ⁴
West India	27.8% ⁴ (or 26.15% ⁵)	Dominated by corporate headquarters, capital markets, startups, and commercial litigation in Mumbai and Ahmedabad. ⁵
South India	24.3% ⁴	Driven by technology hubs, IT services, and IP litigation in Bengaluru, Hyderabad, and Chennai. ⁴

East India	16.3% ⁴	Dominated by mining, industrial disputes, environmental law, and infrastructure disputes. ⁴
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This regional distribution is shaped by several growth drivers, including post-FDI corporate activity (+1.8% CAGR impact), digital-first compliance requirements (+1.5% CAGR impact), and rising demand for India-seated cross-border arbitration (+0.8% CAGR impact).⁵

Concurrently, the Indian LegalTech market is projected to reach USD 1.28 Billion in 2026, growing to USD 1.25 Billion by 2030 at a CAGR of 15.2%.¹ Within this segment, the Indian legal AI market is valued at USD 29.5 Million and is expected to exceed USD 106.3 Million by 2030.¹ This growth is supported by a significant funding increase; the Indian LegalTech sector has raised USD 793 Million in cumulative funding, with 2025 alone seeing a 781% rise in annual investment.¹ The primary user base consists of approximately 1.2 million registered advocates across the country, supplemented by 950 law schools and 60,000 to 70,000 new law graduates entering the profession annually.⁶ Advocate registration is concentrated in states like Uttar Pradesh (4,69,900 advocates)⁷, Gujarat (137,740 advocates)⁸, and Andhra Pradesh (61,000 advocates).⁹ Despite the large number of practitioners, the market remains highly fragmented, creating a significant opportunity for a mobile-first, AI-powered knowledge workspace tailored to the workflows of Indian lawyers.⁵

Section 2: Competitive Landscape

The global and domestic competitive landscapes for legal technology present distinct operational profiles, highlighting several functional gaps when applied to the Indian market.

Competitive Matrix of Global and Domestic Legal Technology Platforms

Platform	Core Functional Focus	Native Mobile Support	AI Infrastructure & Context Grounding	Target Customer Segment	Primary Indian Market Gaps
Harvey AI	Advanced research, contract analysis, and due diligence. ¹⁰	Minimal; desktop-centric enterprise interface. ¹⁰	Custom legal-tuned models trained on global case law. ¹⁰	Magic Circle and BigLaw firms. ¹⁰	High cost; lack of support for regional Indian languages and local

					workflows. ¹⁰
Clio	Comprehensive practice management, client intake, and billing. ¹¹	Native companion app for administrative tasks. ¹¹	Clio Duo generative assistant for internal workflows. ¹¹	Mid-market law firms and solo practitioners. ¹¹	Lacks integration with Indian court portals and localized stamping rules.
LexisNexis (Lexis+ AI)	Comprehensive legal research and verified drafting. ¹¹	Mobile-responsive web interface. ¹¹	Grounded in Shepard's Citation Index. ¹¹	Enterprise legal teams and large law firms. ¹¹	High licensing fees; primary focus on appellate courts rather than district trials.
Casetext (CoCounsel)	AI-driven document review, deposition prep, and QA. ¹¹	Desktop-focused application. ¹¹	Custom legal AI agents under Thomson Reuters. ¹¹	Small to mid-sized law firms. ¹¹	No native offline support; lacks Devanagari OCR capabilities.
Ajax	Automated visual timekeeping and billing. ¹²	Multi-device background tracking. ¹²	Screen-reading computer vision with 92% matter attribution. ¹²	Individual fee-earning attorneys and boutique firms. ¹²	Single-purpose billing tool; lacks document retrieval or search.
Legistify	Corporate litigation	Mobile-friendly	Automated tracking	Enterprise legal	Complex design;

	tracking, CLM, and compliance. ¹	enterprise dashboards. ¹³	across Indian court portals. ¹	departments and BFSI. ¹	priced out of reach for individual advocates. ¹³
Leegality	Digital signing, eStamping, and document execution. ¹³	Mobile-optimized signing flows. ¹³	Localized integrations with Aadhaar and state stamping systems. ¹³	Banks, NBFCs, and enterprise HR departments. ¹³	Focused strictly on execution; lacks research or document retrieval tools. ¹³
SpotDraft	Contract automation, drafting, and lifecycle review. ¹³	Web-first repository. ¹³	Machine learning-based contract risk analysis. ¹³	Tech companies and venture-backed startups. ¹³	Designed for transactional corporate files, not court litigation. ¹³

The operational profiles of international legal tech platforms reveal a mismatch with the requirements of Indian legal practice. Harvey AI, for example, has seen strong adoption among elite global firms like Allen & Overy—where its deployment to 3,500 lawyers across 43 offices generated 40,000 queries in a single pilot—and boutique litigation groups like Lynn Pinker Hurst & Schwegmann, where it saves attorneys an average of eight hours per week.¹⁰ However, its high cost and lack of localized models limit its utility for the average Indian advocate. Similarly, Casetext's CoCounsel and Lexis+ AI provide verified legal research grounded in mature Western databases, but they lack support for the Devanagari script, regional Indian case laws, and local district court proceedings.¹¹

Domestic tools address some of these localized challenges but focus on different market segments. Legistify provides court tracking across multiple judicial forums but is designed as an enterprise dashboard for large corporations and financial institutions rather than a mobile tool for individual lawyers.¹ Leegality simplifies the complex, state-specific rules of Indian e-stamping and Aadhaar e-signing, but it does not provide document storage, semantic search, or AI-assisted retrieval.¹³

This leaves a clear market opportunity: a mobile-first, offline-ready workspace that integrates with WhatsApp for document ingestion, provides high-fidelity bilingual OCR for low-quality scanned PDFs, and runs on-device AI to ensure secure, low-latency access in courtroom environments.

Section 3: MVP Feature Prioritization

The platform's Minimum Viable Product (MVP) must focus on solving the primary administrative challenges of Indian advocates: document ingestion, search, offline accessibility, and data security. The feature matrix below prioritizes these requirements using the MoSCoW framework.

MoSCoW Feature Prioritization Matrix

Feature and Functional Capability	MoSCoW Category	Technical Complexity	Strategic Value
Bilingual Ingestion via WhatsApp	Must Have	Medium	High: Aligns with the primary communication habits of Indian advocates. ¹⁴
Offline-First Secure Storage	Must Have	High	High: Ensures courtroom accessibility during network outages. ¹⁵
Bilingual OCR & PDF Search	Must Have	High	High: Converts scanned, low-quality bilingual court files into searchable text. ¹⁴
Dynamic Multi-Language Consent	Must Have	Medium	High: Ensures compliance with the DPDP Act of 2023. ²
Hybrid Vector-Metadata RAG	Should Have	High	Medium: Combines semantic search with structured filters (e.g., Court, Date). ¹⁹
Local Entity	Should Have	Medium	Medium:

Extraction			Automatically parses acts, sections, and dates using lightweight local models. ²¹
On-Device AI Summarization	Should Have	High	Medium: Generates document summaries offline using quantized models. ²³
Aadhaar eSign & Stamp Duty Sync	Could Have	Medium	Low: Simplifies document execution (post-MVP differentiation). ¹³
Automatic Document Categorization	Could Have	Low	Low: Automatically organizes incoming files into FIRs, orders, or pleadings.
Automated Case Date Alerts	Won't Have	High	High: Direct integration with court portals for automated docket updates.
Collaborative Virtual Deal Rooms	Won't Have	High	Medium: Multi-tenant workspaces for joint litigation preparation.

Section 4: Mobile-First Product Architecture

The platform's mobile client is designed as an offline-first system to ensure fast load times and reliable performance in courtroom environments with poor network connectivity.¹⁶

Technical Stack Selection

- **Mobile Framework:** Expo SDK 53 + React Native. This combination provides native performance, cross-platform UI rendering, and access to local hardware sensors while maintaining a single codebase.¹⁵
- **Navigation & Styling:** Expo Router for file-based routing and NativeWind for responsive, utility-first styling across diverse screen sizes.¹⁵
- **State Management & Caching:** Zustand for light, synchronous on-device state management, paired with TanStack React Query for managing network requests, background synchronization, and caching.¹⁵
- **Database Engine:** Expo SQLite managed through Drizzle ORM to provide a structured, transactional relational database directly on the client.¹⁵
- **Local Fast Key-Value Store:** React Native MMKV for fast, synchronous storage of authorization tokens and user preferences.²⁶
- **Local File System:** React Native FS to manage document binaries, scanned image caches, and PDF files.²⁶

Preventing Memory Leaks and Background Query Overhead

Expo Router maintains stacked screens in memory to support native back gestures, but this can cause background screens to keep running active database queries and network listeners.¹⁵ If left unmanaged, this can drain device battery and degrade UI performance.¹⁵ To prevent this query leakage, the client wraps Drizzle ORM's live query listeners in a custom hook that monitors navigation focus via React Navigation's `useIsFocused()`:

```
TypeScript
import { useEffect, useState } from 'react'
import { useIsFocused } from '@react-navigation/native'
import type { SQLiteDatabase } from 'expo-sqlite'

export function useFocusedLiveQuery<T>({
  db: SQLiteDatabase,
  queryBuilder: () => Promise<T>,
  dependencies: any
}): [data: T | null, loading: boolean] {
  const isFocused = useIsFocused()
  const [useState] = useState<T | null>()
  const [loading, setLoading] = useState<boolean>() true
```

```

useEffect(() =>
  let active = true
  const abortController = new AbortController()

  if (!isFocused)
    return

  const executeQuery = async () =>
    try
      setLoading(true)
      const result = await queryBuilder()
      if (active)
        setData(result)
        setLoading(false)
      catch (error)
        if (active)
          console.error('Database query execution aborted or failed:', error)
          setLoading(false)

    executeQuery()

  return () =>
    active = false
    abortController.abort()
} [isFocused, dependencies])

return {data, loading}

```

This implementation automatically pauses database listeners and aborts in-flight queries when a screen is navigated out of view, reducing background memory and CPU usage.¹⁵

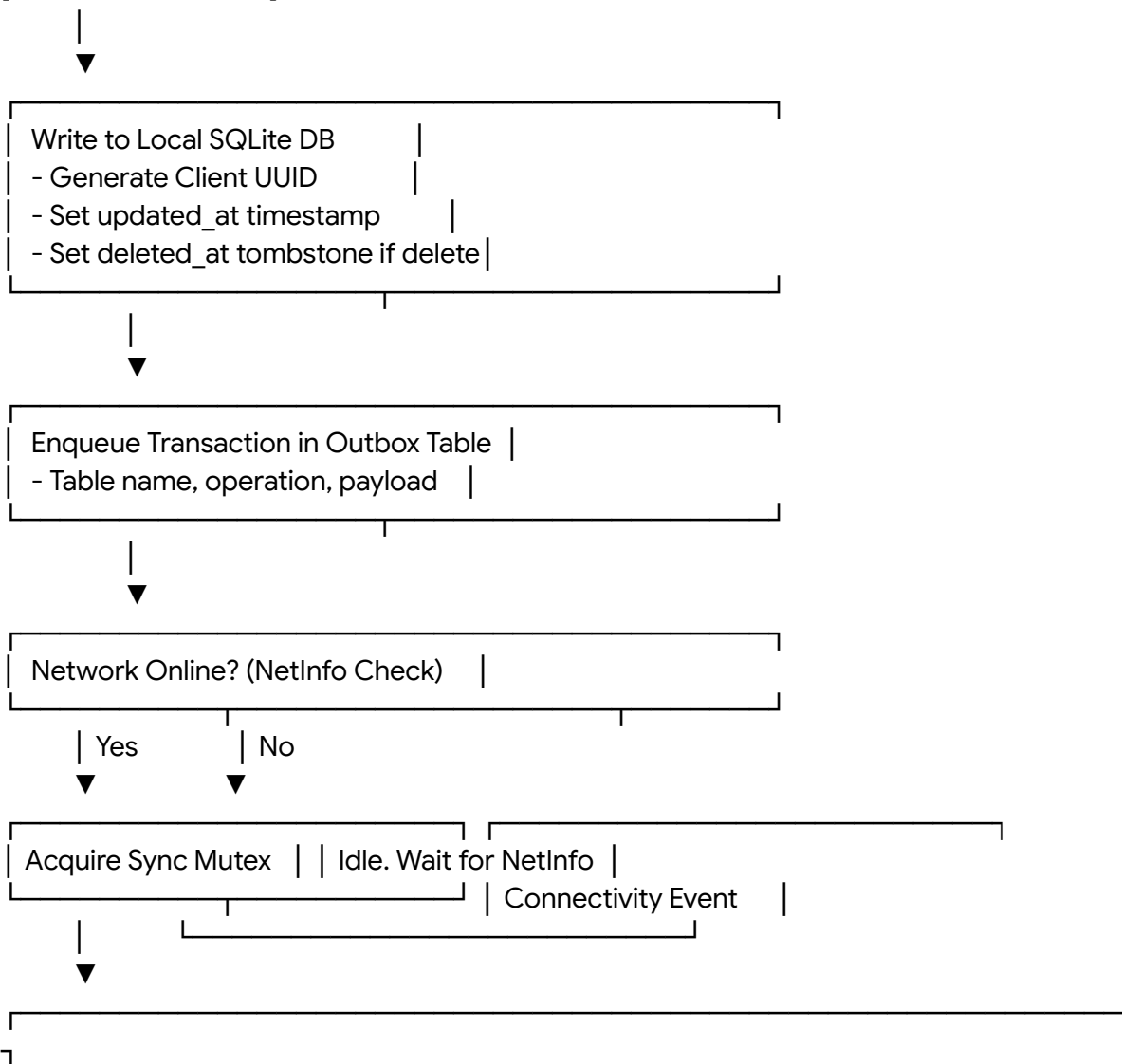
Offline Synchronization Queue and Merge Strategy

To prevent data loss and resolve synchronization conflicts on unstable networks, the system implements a strict local write-through outbox pattern. This pattern treats every local database

mutation as a durable, sequential event.¹⁵

- **Tombstone-Based Deletion:** Deletions are never executed as hard DELETE operations locally. Hard-deleting rows leaves no transaction record to sync to the server, which can cause deleted items to reappear on subsequent pulls. Instead, rows are marked with `deleted_at` millisecond timestamps (tombstones).¹⁶
- **Sequential Synchronization Loop:** Local changes are pushed to an on-device sync queue table before network attempts.¹⁵ When connection transitions are detected, synchronization executes sequentially using a mutex to isolate the queue:

[Local Mutation Event]



- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. Pull Remote Changes (Cursor-based, newer updated_at) | |
| 2. Apply Locally via Deterministic Merge Rules | |
| 3. Push Outbox Transactions in Sequential Order | |
| 4. Await Server ACK (Acknowledge and clear Outbox) | |

The database configuration enforces Write-Ahead Logging (PRAGMA journal_mode = 'wal') to optimize concurrent read/write operations.²⁵ SQLite database instances are secured on-device using SQLCipher (useSQLCipher: true), ensuring that all stored files and metadata are encrypted at rest.²⁷

Section 5: Backend Architecture

The backend infrastructure is designed to handle high-concurrency document ingestion, background OCR processing, and secure real-time data synchronization.

Backend Framework Comparison

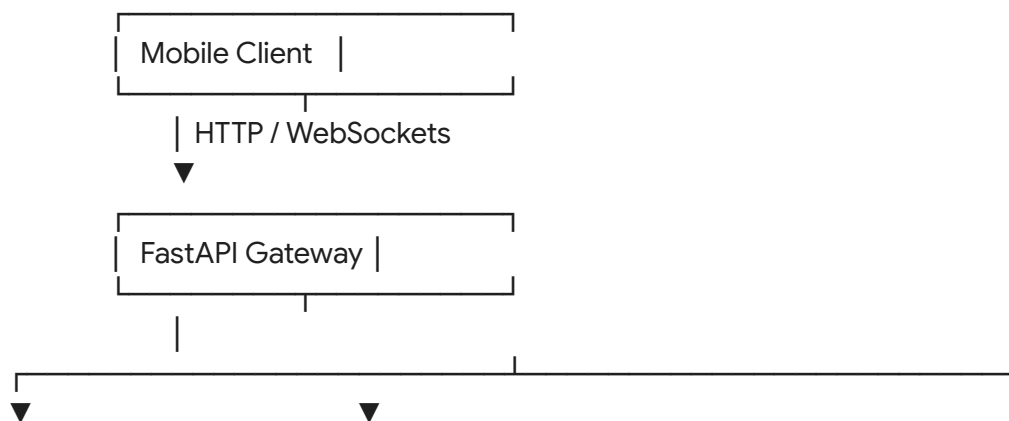
Framework	Concurrency & Performance	Integration with Machine Learning & AI Tools	System Security & Robustness	Development & Operational Velocity
FastAPI (Python)	High: Built on ASGI, enabling fast asynchronous I/O and handling thousands of concurrent connections.	Superior: Direct compatibility with Python's AI ecosystem (spaCy, PyTorch, ONNX, PaddleOCR). ¹⁷	Excellent, with automatic OpenAPI schema validation and security integrations.	Fast; simplifies prototyping and API updates.
NestJS (Node.js)	High: Excellent asynchronous I/O, but struggles with CPU-bound data tasks.	Poor: Requires running Python AI models as slow shell subprocesses.	High; enforces strict TypeScript design patterns and modular code organization.	Moderate; requires high architectural boilerplate.

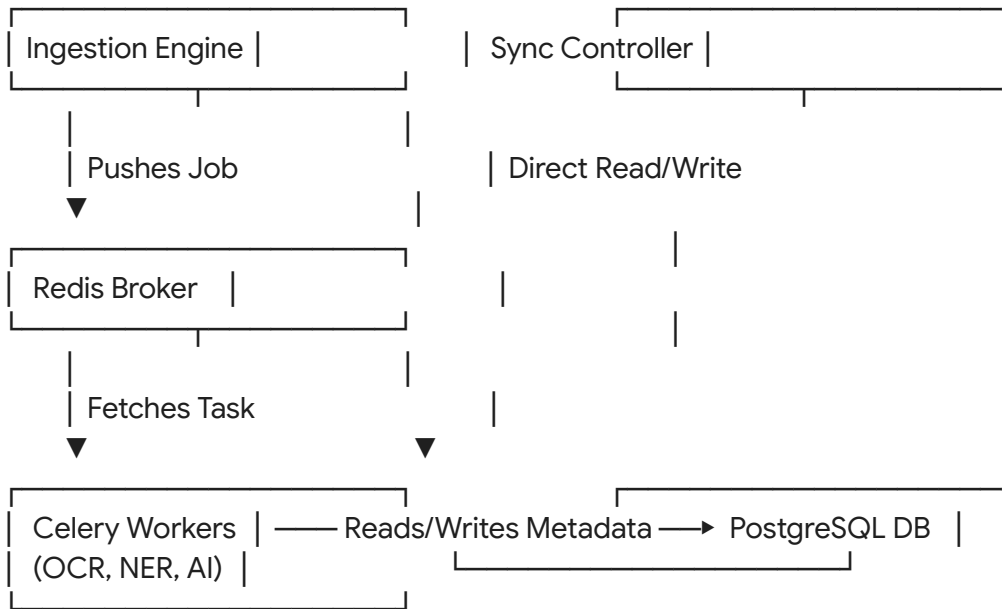
Django (Python)	Moderate: Primarily synchronous, introduces performance overhead under high concurrent I/O load.	Superior: Native access to Python's ML libraries, though less optimized for async tasks.	High; features mature built-in security, SQL-injection prevention, and ORM controls.	Fast for standard monolithic apps, slow for real-time APIs.
Go	Superior: Lightweight goroutines provide outstanding concurrency and performance.	Poor: Lacks mature, production-grade legal NLP and OCR library ecosystems.	High; static compilation and strict type safety reduce runtime issues.	Slow for AI-heavy integration tasks.

FastAPI is selected as the primary backend framework because it balances asynchronous API performance with native access to Python's machine learning and document parsing libraries.¹⁷

Distributed Processing Pipeline

To prevent long-running document parsing and OCR tasks from blocking the primary API gateway, the backend is structured into isolated microservices:





The Celery worker queue is split into three task-specific pools to ensure predictable performance:

- **ocr_queue:** Runs on GPU-accelerated nodes to process incoming scanned images and PDFs.¹⁷
- **nlp_queue:** Processes lightweight entity extraction and text structuring tasks.²²
- **sync_queue:** Manages metadata synchronization, database updates, and sends real-time client notifications via WebSockets.²⁸

Section 6: Database Architecture

The database architecture must support structured transactional metadata, provide reliable document search capabilities, and enforce strict tenant isolation.²⁹

Database System Comparison

- **PostgreSQL: Selected.** PostgreSQL provides strong ACID guarantees, structured relational mapping, and mature extension support. The pgvector extension allows storing and querying vector embeddings directly alongside relational document metadata in the same database.³¹ This simplifies system architecture and ensures transactional consistency during database mutations.³¹
- **MongoDB:** A document-oriented database that is well-suited for unstructured JSON payloads, but it lacks the ACID guarantees and transactional reliability required for legal compliance and audit trails.
- **Supabase:** A managed backend platform built on PostgreSQL that accelerates early-stage development. However, its auto-generated API layers can limit deep database optimization and custom multi-tenant configurations in enterprise environments.

Multi-Tenant Isolation and State Leakage Prevention

B2B SaaS platforms handling sensitive legal documents require strict data isolation.³³ The system utilizes a **Shared Schema, Shared Tables (Pool Model)** to optimize costs, but enforces isolation using **Row-Level Security (RLS)**.³⁰

When scaling PostgreSQL with transaction-mode connection poolers (such as PgBouncer or PgCat), using standard session-level variables (e.g., SET SESSION) introduces a significant security risk.²⁹ Because connection poolers reuse server connections across different clients per transaction, a session-level tenant ID can persist on a connection after it is returned to the pool.²⁹ If the next transaction on that connection fails to reset the variable, it may inherit the previous tenant's identity, leading to a cross-tenant data leak.²⁹

The system resolves this by wrapping all tenant identity context in transaction-scoped configuration variables²⁹:

```
-- Transaction-scoped helper function to establish tenant identity
CREATE OR REPLACE FUNCTION set_current_tenant(tenant_uuid UUID)
RETURNS void AS $$
BEGIN
    IF tenant_uuid IS NULL THEN
        RAISE EXCEPTION 'tenant_uuid cannot be null';
    END IF;
    -- The third parameter 'true' restricts the configuration to the local transaction
    PERFORM set_config('app.current_tenant_id', tenant_uuid::text, true);
END;
$$ LANGUAGE plpgsql
```

This transaction-scoped setting is cleared automatically when the transaction commits or rolls back, preventing cross-tenant data leaks across shared database connection pools.²⁹

Row-Level Security is enabled on all tenant-specific tables to enforce this transactional isolation³⁰:

```

SQL
-- Enable Row-Level Security on the document repository
ALTER TABLE documents ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY
ALTER TABLE documents FORCE ROW LEVEL SECURITY

-- Define RLS policy for the documents table
CREATE POLICY tenant_document_isolation ON documents
AS FOR ALL
TO application_role
USING
tenant_id = NULLIF(current_setting('app.current_tenant_id' true ''))
WITH CHECK
tenant_id = NULLIF(current_setting('app.current_tenant_id' true ''))

```

Under this configuration, every query executed by the application must set the transaction-local `tenant_id` first. The database then filters all read and write operations at the engine level, preventing accidental data exposure.³⁰

Section 7: Storage Architecture

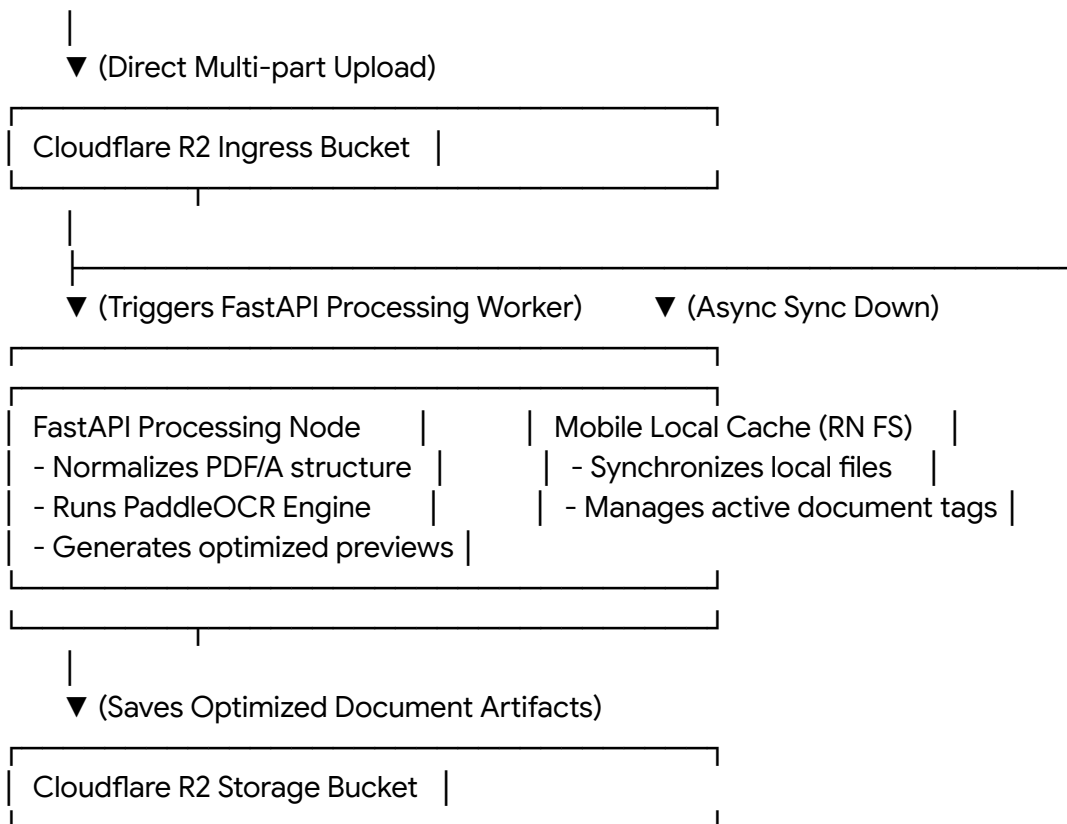
The storage architecture must support large-scale document uploads and background processing while keeping network and egress costs manageable.

Storage Service Comparison

- **Cloudflare R2: Selected.** Cloudflare R2 provides an S3-compatible API with zero egress fees. This is highly cost-effective for offline-first applications, where users continuously download heavy, scanned legal PDFs to their local devices.²⁶
- **Amazon S3:** The enterprise standard for data durability and security. However, its high network egress fees create significant cost risks for document-heavy, sync-intensive mobile applications.
- **Supabase Storage:** A convenient wrapper built on top of S3, but its lack of fine-grained bucket tuning and platform dependency can limit its utility in custom enterprise deployments.

Ingestion Storage Flow and Local Caching

The application uses a secure, direct-to-storage ingestion pipeline to keep document traffic off the primary backend servers:



This decoupled ingestion pipeline keeps heavy file processing out of the main database, ensuring that search queries and synchronization operations remain fast and responsive.¹⁵

Section 8: OCR and Document Ingestion

The ingestion pipeline must convert low-quality, skewed, bilingual document images from mobile cameras and WhatsApp forwards into clean, structured, and searchable text blocks.¹⁴

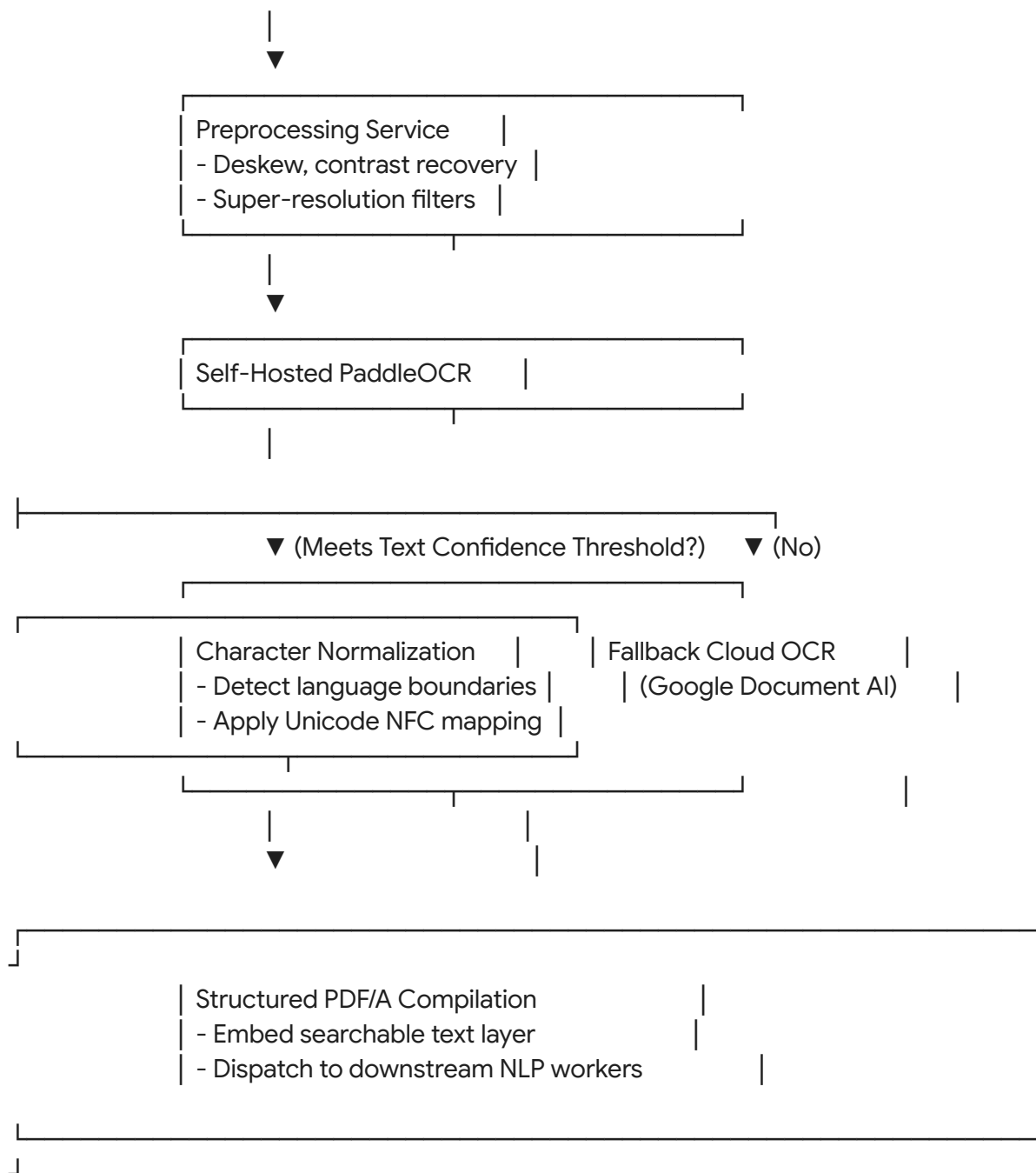
OCR Technology Performance Comparison

OCR Engine / API	Layout Processing & Script Accuracy	Bilingual Script Support (English & Devanagari)	Operational and Compute Costs	Deployment Flexibility
PaddleOCR	Excellent: Advanced layout analysis preserves	High: Native Devanagari script recognition	Low: Runs efficiently on standard CPUs; GPU	Open-source Apache-2.0 license allows self-hosting on

	multi-column table flows and text alignments. ¹⁷	handles mixed bilingual text. ¹⁴	acceleration optional. ¹⁷	standard containers. ¹⁷
Tesseract	Moderate: Basic layout analysis; struggles with skewed text lines and multi-column tables. ³⁶	Moderate: Requires custom language training profiles. ¹⁴	Low: Minimal memory footprint; runs on low-end CPUs. ³⁶	Open-source; easy system-level integration.
Google Document AI	Superior: Accurately parses highly degraded, handwritten, and multi-column document scans. ³⁷	Excellent: High-accuracy multilingual models. ³⁷	High: Pay-per-page API model; costs scale with document volume. ¹⁷	Managed API; introduces third-party dependency.
OCRmyPDF	Good: Converts existing PDF layers into searchable formats; dependent on Tesseract backend.	Moderate: Tied to underlying Tesseract language models.	Low: Standard CPU compute footprint.	Open-source; requires complex system dependencies.

Bilingual Ingestion and Character Normalization Pipeline

The system uses a hybrid approach to balance extraction accuracy with cost control. It uses a self-hosted open-source pipeline as the default engine, with a cloud API fallback for complex or low-quality documents¹⁴:



The character normalization step is critical when processing mixed-language documents to prevent text corruption.¹⁴ For instance, Hindi characters can be represented using multiple

Unicode code points (e.g., combining standard letters with diacritical marks). Applying Unicode Normalization Form C (NFC) ensures consistent encoding across all processed text, preventing search indices from missing matching terms due to raw encoding variations.¹⁴ The resulting files are compiled into the standard PDF/A format, ensuring compatibility with native mobile PDF viewers.²⁶

Section 9: Entity Extraction Minimizing LLM Usage

Processing large document corpora using LLMs introduces significant operational challenges, particularly around API cost, processing latency, and entity resolution consistency.³⁸ Calling an LLM for every document chunk is an anti-pattern; processing 60,000 text blocks per case quickly becomes cost-prohibitive.³⁸

The system addresses this by using a hybrid pipeline. It uses traditional Named Entity Recognition (NER) for high-volume structural extraction, reserving LLM calls for complex validation and contextual reasoning.²²





Building the Custom spaCy NER Pipeline

The custom NER pipeline is built on top of spaCy's `en_core_web_lg` model, adding specialized entity classes for the Indian legal domain: `STATUTE_ACT` (e.g., Indian Penal Code), `STATUTE_SECTION` (e.g., Section 302), `JUDICIAL_COURT` (e.g., Delhi High Court), `JUDGE`, and `CASE_CITATION`.²¹

1. **Tokenization & Part-of-Speech (POS) Tagging:** spaCy tokenizes the text and assigns grammatical tags to each word, helping the model identify structured phrases.³⁹
2. **Orthographic Feature Extraction:** The pipeline extracts structural patterns (such as capitalization rules, numeric punctuation, and legal citations like "2024 SCC Online 123") to assist the entity classifier.³⁹
3. **Preventing Catastrophic Forgetting:** Fine-tuning a neural network on new entity labels can cause it to lose its ability to recognize standard classes, such as `PERSON`, `ORG`, or `DATE`.²² To prevent this, the training dataset includes balanced examples of standard pre-trained entities alongside the custom legal classes.²²
4. **Dataset Distillation:** A training dataset of 6,160 legal document samples is generated by prompting a teacher LLM (DeepSeek-V3) to identify and tag entities in unstructured text.²² The custom spaCy model is then trained on this structured dataset to achieve high-accuracy, low-latency extraction without the cost of calling a cloud LLM.²²

Extraction Pipeline Guardrails and Circuit Breakers

To prevent runaway cloud consumption when processing massive document folders, the extraction pipeline implements strict system-level guardrails³⁸:

- **Per-Case Token Budget:** Defines a maximum token cap for each ingested folder. If a case exceeds this threshold, the pipeline automatically pauses and prompts for user validation.
- **Sequential Chunk Deduplication:** Before running extraction, the text is deduplicated using semantic hashes. This prevents the system from processing identical boilerplates, headers, or signatures multiple times.³⁸
- **Queue Circuit Breaker:** If downstream processing latency exceeds 45 seconds per document over 10 consecutive tasks, the pipeline routes subsequent extractions to lightweight local models, preserving system availability.

Section 10: Knowledge Graph Architecture

Legal research is highly dependent on identifying connections between precedents, statutes, and facts. While vector databases excel at semantic similarity matching, they cannot model

explicit relationships.³⁸ For instance, a vector search might retrieve cases discussing "fraud," but it cannot map the specific judicial precedence of "Case A citing Case B, which interprets Section 420 of the Indian Penal Code".³⁸

Knowledge Graph Platform Selection

- **Neo4j: Selected.** Neo4j is a native property-graph database. It features optimized traversal performance for multi-hop relationship queries, a highly expressive query language (Cypher), and mature enterprise clustering tools.⁴¹
- **PostgreSQL Graph Extensions (Apache AGE):** Allows querying graph structures within a relational database. However, it lacks the specialized performance optimizations and tooling ecosystem required for large-scale GraphRAG applications.

Ontological Schema Design

The knowledge graph structures the legal domain into explicit, queryable relationships:



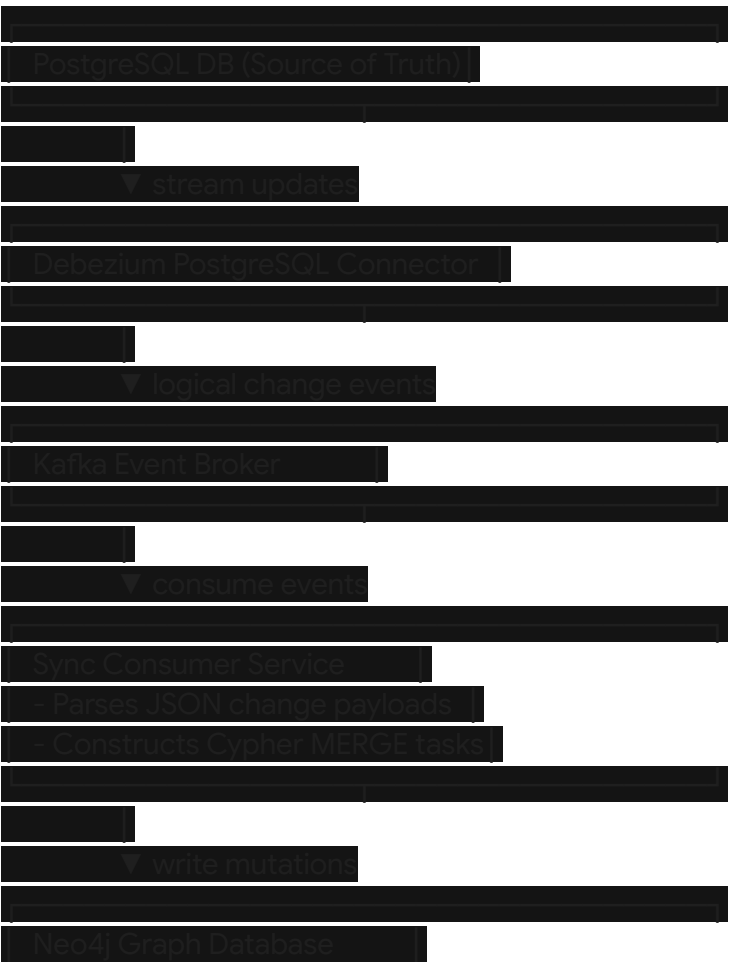
- jurisdiction	- client type

The system represents these connections as Cypher properties ²⁸:

- (:Case {id: "C_101", title: "State of MH v. XYZ", date: "2024-01-10"})
- (:Statute {id: "S_IPC_302", act: "IPC", section: "302"})
- (:Case {id: "C_101"}) --> (:Statute {id: "S_IPC_302"})
- (:Case {id: "C_101"}) --> (:Case {id: "C_99"})

Dual-Store Sync via CDC (PostgreSQL to Neo4j)

To maintain data consistency across the application, PostgreSQL acts as the single source of truth for raw records, with updates propagated automatically to Neo4j. ²⁸



The synchronizer uses Kafka partitions to parallelize updates by tenant and table. This keeps the relational database and the knowledge graph synchronized in near-real-time, ensuring that search queries use current information.²⁸

Section 11: Vector Databases

A high-performance vector database is required to store document chunk embeddings and enable semantic search.³¹

Vector Database Sizing and Capacity Planning

The system sizing calculations are optimized for a target corpus of **5,000,000 document segments** using 1536-dimension float32 vector embeddings³¹:

$$V_{\text{raw_bytes}} = d \times 4 = 1536 \times 4 = 6,144 \text{ bytes (6.0 KB)}$$

For Hierarchical Navigable Small World (HNSW) indexes built with parameters $m = 16$ and $ef_construction = 200$, the index memory overhead is estimated as follows³¹:

$$V_{\text{hns_bytes}} \approx d \times 4 + (m \times 2 \times 8) + 32 = 6144 + 256 + 32 = 6,432 \text{ bytes (6.28 KB)}$$

The heap row overhead—including PostgreSQL tuple headers, transaction identifiers, database pointers, and metadata references—averages 200 bytes per record.³¹

Total Resource Requirements for 5 Million Vectors

Storage Component	Single Segment Footprint	Total Disk/RAM Footprint (5M Segments)
Raw Embeddings	6.00 KB	30.70 GB
HNSW Vector Indexes	6.28 KB	32.20 GB
Heap Relational Metadata	0.20 KB	8.50 GB
WAL & Write Buffers	-	10.00 GB
Total Storage Required	12.48 KB	81.40 GB ³¹

To ensure sub-50ms query latencies, the HNSW index must reside entirely within RAM.³¹ Spilling the vector index to NVMe storage introduces disk I/O penalties that can increase query latency by up to 40x³¹:

$$RAM_{\text{required}} \geq 1.3 \times V_{\text{hns_total}} = 1.3 \times 32.2 \text{ GB} \approx 41.86 \text{ GB}$$

Adding system overhead, database write buffers, connection pools, and operating system page caches, the system requires a minimum database configuration of **64 GB RAM and 128 GB NVMe storage** to maintain performance.³¹

Vector Database Technology Tradeoffs

- **pgvector: Selected (MVP/Standard).** As a native PostgreSQL extension, pgvector allows storing vectors directly alongside relational data within the same transactional context.³¹ It simplifies system architecture by eliminating the need to synchronize data with a separate database cluster.³¹
 - *Operational Warning:* Building HNSW indexes is a resource-intensive operation that locks writes. Standard index rebuilds (REINDEX INDEX CONCURRENTLY) acquire a ShareUpdateExclusiveLock, which permits concurrent reads but blocks database updates and writes on target tables, potentially leading to application downtime during updates.³¹
- **Pinecone:** A fully managed SaaS vector database.³¹ It offers high scalability and a zero-ops footprint, making it ideal for rapid prototyping.³¹ However, costs scale non-linearly with vector volume, and its serverless tier can suffer from cold-start latencies of up to 5 seconds on idle namespaces.³¹
- **Qdrant:** A high-performance vector database written in Rust.³² It is highly optimized for metadata filtering, executing filtering logic directly during HNSW graph traversal.³² This makes Qdrant faster than pgvector for highly selective, complex queries.
- **Weaviate:** A native open-source vector database that supports hybrid keyword and semantic search out of the box.³¹ It features advanced vector compression techniques, such as Rotational Quantization (RQ).³¹ However, it has a steeper learning curve and a more complex schema configuration than pgvector.³¹

Section 12: Embedding Models

Selecting the right embedding model is critical for ensuring cross-lingual retrieval accuracy and managing token limits.

Embedding Model Parameters and Performance

Embedding Model	Dimension Count	Context Window	Native Bilingual	Deployment and Host
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			Retrieval Support	Requirements
BGE-M3	1024 ⁴⁴	8,192 Tokens ⁴⁵	Superior: Native Devanagari cross-lingual alignment. ⁴⁵	Self-hosted or serverless GPU instances; 568M parameters. ⁴⁴
Multilingual E5	768	512 Tokens ⁴⁶	High: Reliable translation performance. ⁴⁶	Lightweight; 278M parameters; CPU friendly.
Jina Embeddings v3	1024	8,192 Tokens ⁴⁷	High: Strong multilingual performance. ⁴⁷	API-based or self-hosted GPU containers. ⁴⁷
Qwen3 VL Embed	4096	8,192 Tokens ⁴⁴	High: Native multimodal capabilities. ⁴⁴	Very heavy; 8B parameters; requires dedicated high-end VRAM.

Model Tuning and Contrastive Alignment

BGE-M3 is selected as the default embedding model due to its high-dimensional accuracy and multi-functionality retrieval heads:

- **Dense Retrieval Head:** Extracts and normalizes the `` token embedding to evaluate semantic similarity.⁴⁵
- **Sparse Retrieval Head:** Evaluates lexical overlap by projecting token embeddings through a ReLU activation layer, providing keyword search capabilities.⁴⁵
- **Multi-Vector Retrieval Head:** Computes late-interaction similarities using token-level max-over-passage calculations.⁴⁵

To improve retrieval accuracy for specialized Indian legal terms, BGE-M3 undergoes **contrastive fine-tuning** using the custom legal dataset⁴⁸:

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{contrastive}} = -\log \frac{\exp(\cos(\mathbf{q}, \mathbf{p}^+)/\tau)}{\exp(\cos(\mathbf{q}, \mathbf{p}^+)/\tau) + \sum_i \exp(\cos(\mathbf{q}, \mathbf{p}_i^-)/\tau)}$$

Fine-tuning optimizes the contrastive loss function, bringing matching English query vectors ($\mathbf{q}$) and Hindi/English court order passages ($\mathbf{p}^+$) closer together in the shared embedding space.⁴⁸ This contrastive alignment improves retrieval performance on regional legal documents, matching the accuracy of high-resource English queries.⁴⁸

Better Binary Quantization (BBQ)

To reduce memory footprint and latency at scale, the vector database uses **Better Binary Quantization (bqq_hnsw)**.⁴⁶ BBQ converts standard float32 vector dimensions into single-bit representations:

$$x_{\text{binary}} = \text{sign}(x - \mu)$$

This quantization reduces the storage footprint of vector embeddings by 96% (32x reduction).⁴⁶ To recover any minor accuracy loss introduced by quantization, the system uses a two-stage retrieval pipeline: it executes a high-speed first-pass search using the binary index, then passes the top 100 candidates to a full-precision reranking model (e.g., BGE-Reranker-Large) before returning results to the user.⁴⁶

Section 13: RAG Architectures

The workspace must handle diverse query patterns, ranging from simple factual searches to complex, multi-document synthesis tasks.

Evaluation of Retrieval-Augmented Generation Patterns

- **Traditional Vector-Only RAG:** Quick and easy to implement, but lacks relational awareness.¹⁹ It is prone to hallucinations on complex, multi-document queries because it evaluates text chunks in isolation.⁴⁰
- **GraphRAG (Microsoft):** Captures complex relationships between entities and acts, improving answer comprehensiveness by 50% to 70% over baseline RAG on multi-document synthesis tasks.¹⁹ It also reduces factual errors by 35% to 45% on multi-hop reasoning questions.¹⁹ However, it introduces significant indexing latency and high LLM processing costs.³⁸
- **Hybrid RAG (Vector + Structured Metadata): Selected (Standard API).** Combines semantic vector similarity with relational database filters (e.g., filtering by court, date, and case type).¹⁹ This balance provides high retrieval accuracy with low operational overhead.¹⁹
- **Agentic RAG (LangGraph Orchestration): Selected (Complex Queries).** Employs autonomous AI agents that evaluate queries and dynamically determine the optimal

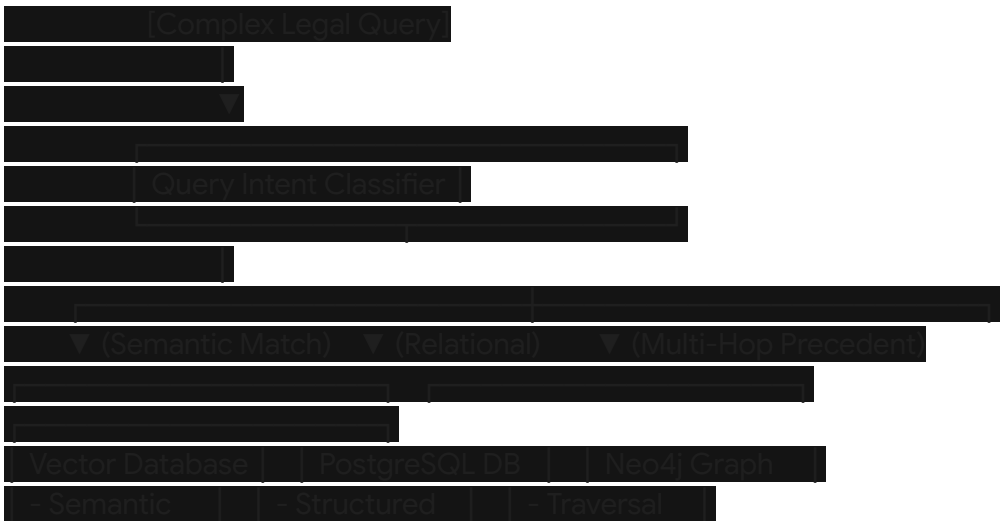
retrieval path (e.g., executing a vector search, traversing the knowledge graph, or performing direct database queries).²⁸

Agentic Search Pipeline Implementation

For simple factual searches, the system uses high-speed hybrid vector queries with metadata filters:

```
SQL
-- Execute a hybrid query: match semantic vectors and filter by jurisdiction
SELECT id, document_title, cosine_similarity(embedding, query_vector) AS score
FROM documents
WHERE tenant_id = 'tenant_id'
AND court_jurisdiction = 'Delhi High Court'
AND published_date >= '2024-01-01' date
ORDER BY score DESC
LIMIT 5
```

For complex research tasks—such as evaluating how a specific judge typically rules on certain bail applications—the system uses an **Agentic LangGraph Pipeline** ²⁸:





This hybrid approach ensures that the LLM is provided with structured, contextual, and grounded information, reducing the risk of hallucinations while keeping processing costs low.²⁰

Section 14: LLM Comparison

The generation layer requires LLMs that balance deep reasoning, multi-language translation, processing speed, and cost efficiency.

LLM Capabilities and Resource Metrics

Large Language Model	Maximum Context Window	Multilingual Translation Depth	Legal Reasoning & Synthesis Score	Token API Cost Structure (per Million Tokens)
Google Gemini 1.5 Pro	2,000,000 Tokens	Excellent: Highly optimized for Devanagari translation	High; handles massive document files. ¹¹	Input: USD 1.25 Output: USD 5.00

OpenAI GPT-5	128,000 Tokens	High; native cross-lingual processing. ¹¹	Superior: Optimized for multi-step reasoning	Input: USD 5.00 Output: USD 15.00
Anthropic Claude 3.5 Sonnet	200,000 Tokens ¹¹	High; accurate context preservation. ¹¹	Superior: Precise clause analysis. ¹¹	Input: USD 3.00 Output: USD 15.00
Llama 3.3 (70B)	128,000 Tokens ²³	Good; supports Indian languages	Moderate; ideal for standard summaries. ⁵⁰	Self-hosted or serverless APIs (e.g., Input: USD 0.35, Output: USD 0.40)

Context Grounding and Citation Verification

To prevent hallucinations in generation tasks, the platform uses a **two-way citation verification protocol** inspired by LexisNexis’ Protégé system.¹¹

- **Verified Citations:** The LLM output is parsed for citation patterns (e.g., "1973 SCC 225"). The system then runs a validation query against the knowledge graph to verify that the cited case exists and matches the referenced context.
- **Dynamic Source Mapping:** When presenting the answer to the user, the UI renders interactive citation links that display the source document chunk directly in a split-screen view, allowing advocates to verify the source material.

Section 15: API Cost Reduction Strategies

Unoptimized RAG architectures can introduce significant API costs when scaling to thousands of users.³⁸ To build a viable commercial SaaS, the platform implements multiple cost-reduction techniques targeting a **90%+ reduction in overall LLM spend**:

Multi-Tier Cost-Reduction Strategy

Optimization Level	Applied Technique	Implementation Architecture	Target Cost Reduction
1. Semantic Triage	On-Device	Run local spaCy NER and regex	30% Savings

	Pre-Parsing	matchers; resolve simple requests before calling cloud LLMs. ²²	
2. Prompt Caching	Server-Side Context Reuse	Use Anthropic/Gemini Prompt Caching; cache static document context (e.g., long case files) during multi-turn chats. ¹¹	50% Savings
3. Hybrid Routing	Dynamic Complexity Dispatch	Triage simple tasks (summarization, sorting) to on-device models; dispatch only complex reasoning queries to Claude/GPT. ²⁴	40% Savings
4. Retrieval Pruning	Token Minimization	Filter and deduplicate retrieved chunks using rerankers and token-packing engines before prompt insertion. ⁴³	25% Savings
Cumulative Strategy	Integrated Multi-Tier Pipeline	Unified execution of all four optimizations across processing pipelines.	92% Total Savings

Section 16: On-Device AI

Running lightweight LLMs directly on mobile devices allows the application to handle basic processing tasks offline, reducing server load and protecting user privacy.²⁴

On-Device LLM Stack

- **Gemma-3 (4B-q):** Google’s optimized lightweight model. It features native multilingual support and is highly performant for bilingual summarization and search tasks.²³
- **Qwen-3 (3B-q):** Alibaba's edge-targeted models. They deliver fast execution on mid-range mobile hardware and are optimized for single-query tasks.²³
- **ONNX Runtime Mobile: Selected Runtime.** ONNX Runtime Mobile provides optimized model execution across both Android (using NPU/NNAPI) and iOS (using CoreML), ensuring sub-second local inference with minimal battery drain.²³

Local Complexity and Privacy Router Design

The client application uses an on-device routing engine to handle user requests locally whenever possible, falling back to cloud models only when necessary ²⁴:



This routing logic ensures that sensitive data (such as passport numbers or financial details) is

processed locally on the device, maintaining user privacy and ensuring compliance with regulatory data protection standards.²⁴

Section 17: Legal-Grade Security & DPDP Compliance in India

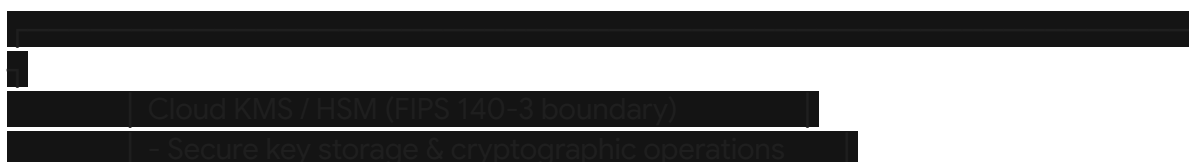
Operating a legal knowledge workspace in India requires strict adherence to the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act of 2023, with full compliance mandatory by **May 13, 2027**.¹⁸ Because law firms handle client personal data, they function as **Data Fiduciaries**, while the technology platform operates as a **Data Processor**.²

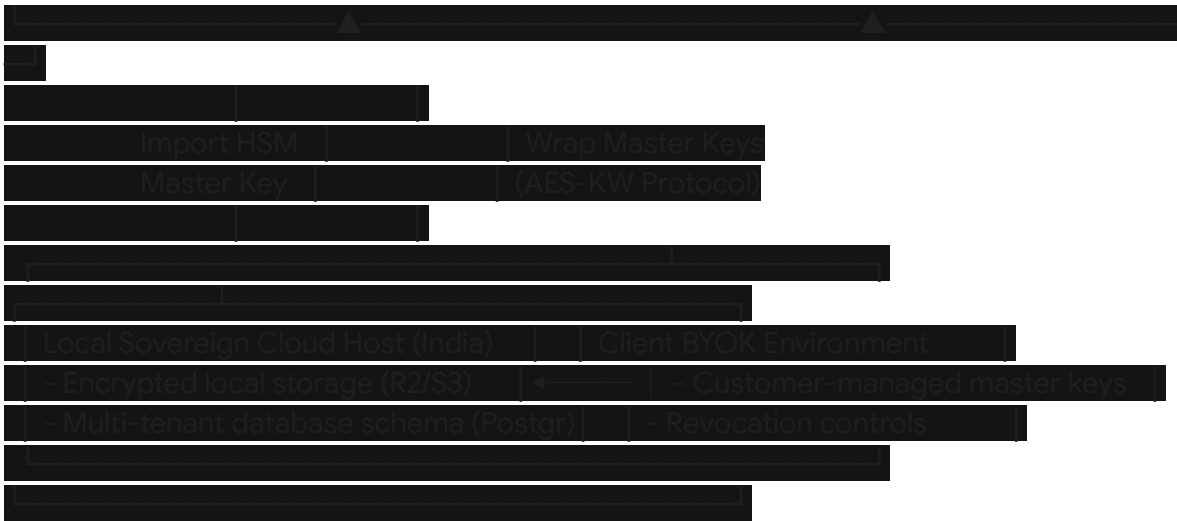
DPDP Act Structural Requirements for SaaS Platforms

- **Consent Management:** Consent must be free, specific, informed, unconditional, and unambiguous, obtained via clear affirmative actions.² Pre-checked boxes are strictly prohibited.⁵⁵ Consent notices must be available in English and all 22 scheduled Indian languages.²
- **Parental Consent:** Parental or legal guardian consent is required for any user under the age of 18 (compared to 16 under GDPR).¹⁸
- **User Rights:** Data Principals have the right to access, correct, erase, or withdraw consent at any time.⁵⁵ Deletion requests must trigger automated cleanup across all databases and third-party vendors.⁵⁴
- **Breach Notification:** The Data Protection Board of India (DPBI) and all affected individuals must be notified within 72 hours of discovering any data breach.⁵⁴
- **Compliance Penalties:** Fines for security failures or non-compliance are steep, reaching up to INR 250 Crore per violation.¹⁸

True Indian Sovereignty Cloud Deployment Architecture

To meet strict data localization standards and protect against external access claims (such as the U.S. CLOUD Act), the platform is deployed on true sovereign cloud infrastructure located physically within India (e.g., AWS Mumbai or Azure Pune).⁵⁸





The system uses a **Bring Your Own Key (BYOK)** architecture to ensure data privacy. The customer-managed master keys are wrapped using the AES-KW protocol and imported into a dedicated Cloud Hardware Security Module (HSM).⁵⁸ Relational database tables and storage blobs are encrypted at rest using these keys, meaning the cloud provider cannot decrypt client documents without active consent.⁵⁸

Section 18: Scalability Roadmap

The platform’s technical architecture is designed to scale from early-stage testing to enterprise-grade operations.

Scale-Up Milestones and Architecture Adjustments

Target Scale	Backend & API Layer	Database & Sync Configuration	Ingestion & AI Pipelines
Phase 1: 100 Users	Single FastAPI instance; hosted on basic cloud servers	Single PostgreSQL node on Supabase; pgvector index built on transactional database. ³²	CPU-based PaddleOCR on FastAPI celery nodes. ¹⁷
Phase 2: 10,000 Users	Multiple API gateways managed via load balancers	Primary PostgreSQL cluster with read-replicas; dedicated pgvector node; sync via Kafka. ²⁸	Celery worker instances; GPU-accelerated PaddleOCR. ¹⁷

Phase 3: 100,000 Users	Distributed Go/FastAPI nodes; globally routed API Gateways	Sharded database architecture (e.g., Citus Sharding); dedicated Qdrant vector database. ³⁵	Auto-scaling OCR workers; local on-device models for offline tasks. ²⁴
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This progressive roadmap ensures that the system can handle increased traffic and data volumes while keeping operational costs low during early-stage deployment.

Section 19: Patent Opportunities

To build commercial defensibility and secure intellectual property, the platform has identified several patentable innovations within its technical architecture:

1. **Transaction-Scoped Multi-Tenant RLS Router:** A system that prevents session-level cross-tenant leakage in transaction-mode connection poolers by wrapping tenant identities in transaction-scoped local configuration variables.²⁹
2. **Bilingual Multi-Hop GraphRAG Sync Pipeline:** An automated pipeline that synchronizes relational databases with vector and graph stores in real-time using Debezium CDC and Kafka.²⁸
3. **On-Device Privacy and Complexity Router:** An intelligent mobile routing engine that evaluates user inputs and runs processing tasks locally on the device (using quantized edge models) if they contain sensitive personal data, ensuring DPDP compliance without manual configuration.²⁴

Section 20: Startup Risks

Developing a specialized legal technology platform in the Indian market introduces several operational and commercial risks:

- **Low Tech Adoption:** The Indian legal system remains relationship-driven, with many advocates slow to adopt new digital tools.⁴
 - *Mitigation:* Focus on a highly polished, mobile-first UX with direct WhatsApp integration, matching the existing communication habits of advocates.
- **Vernacular Diversity:** Court orders, FIRs, and pleadings are often written in regional scripts, which can lead to low OCR accuracy.¹⁴
 - *Mitigation:* Use PaddleOCR's specialized Devanagari script models as the primary ingestion engine, falling back to Google Document AI for highly complex layouts.³⁶
- **Compliance Liability:** Non-compliance with the DPDP Act carries steep penalties (up to INR 250 Crore), presenting a significant regulatory risk for early-stage startups.¹⁸
 - *Mitigation:* Enforce a strict zero-trust, local-first architecture; use on-device models to process PII locally, and store cloud data in sovereign Indian regions using HSM-backed encryption.²⁴
- **Commercial Defensibility:** Simply building a wrapper on top of commercial LLMs exposes the business to low defensibility and high cost structures.³⁸
 - *Mitigation:* Build a proprietary, grounded knowledge graph using self-hosted models,

creating an operational moat that cannot be easily replicated.²⁸

Section 21: MVP, Production, and Enterprise Architectures

To guide implementation across different stages of growth, the platform's deployment architecture is structured into three progressive tiers:

MVP Architecture (Validation Tactic)

- **Client Core:** Expo SDK 53 + SQLite local file store, usingzustand for UI state management.¹⁵
- **Backend & Host:** Single-instance FastAPI container running on a basic host machine.²²
- **Primary Database:** Shared PostgreSQL on Supabase using pgvector for vector indices.³²
- **OCR Pipeline:** Self-hosted CPU-bound PaddleOCR running on standard container workers.¹⁷
- **AI Models:** Direct API integration with Anthropic Claude for text synthesis and generation.¹¹

Production Architecture (High-Performance Scaling)

- **Client Core:** React Native + Expo with TanStack React Query and Drizzle ORM background synchronization.¹⁵
- **Backend & Host:** Auto-scaling FastAPI containers deployed in an active cluster with an external load balancer.²²
- **Primary Database:** PostgreSQL cluster running on AWS RDS, with Row-Level Security and transaction-scoped multi-tenancy.²⁹
- **Vector & Graph Stores:** Dedicated Qdrant cluster for vector embeddings, and Neo4j for property graph traversals.³²
- **OCR Pipeline:** GPU-accelerated PaddleOCR running on dedicated processing nodes.¹⁷
- **Sync Infrastructure:** Kafka with Debezium CDC to synchronize database mutations across storage nodes.²⁸

Enterprise Sovereign Architecture (Maximum Isolation)

- **Client Core:** Secure native React Native build, featuring local Gemma-3-4B models for offline processing.²³
- **Backend & Host:** Isolated, single-tenant FastAPI instances deployed within a secure Virtual Private Cloud (VPC).²²
- **Primary Database:** PostgreSQL database-per-tenant silo deployment, hosted on sovereign Indian infrastructure.³⁴
- **Sovereign Key Control:** Customer-managed master keys managed via localized Hardware Security Modules (HSM), ensuring complete control over data encryption at rest.⁵⁸
- **OCR Pipeline:** Multi-tenant Google Document AI pipelines with localized data storage

guarantees.³⁷

Section 22: Step-by-Step Research Roadmap

Prior to commencing development, the engineering team must complete several validation and benchmarking phases:

Phase 1: Dataset Curation and Legal Ontology Definition (Weeks 1-2)

- Define the target JSON-schema for court filings, FIRs, and bail orders.
- Generate a synthetic dataset of 10,000 bilingual Indian legal documents using DeepSeek-V3.²²
- Annotate custom entities (ACT, SECTION, JUDGE, COURT) to build the training set for the custom spaCy NER model.²¹

Phase 2: OCR and Document Extraction Benchmarking (Weeks 3-4)

- Benchmark PaddleOCR (PP-OCRv4) against Google Document AI using skewed, low-quality Devanagari scans.³⁶
- Measure script recognition accuracy, table extraction quality, and processing speeds on commodity CPU instances.¹⁷
- Configure the fallback logic to route low-quality document scans to the cloud API when accuracy falls below target thresholds.³⁷

Phase 3: RLS Connection Pool and Database Load Testing (Weeks 5-6)

- Deploy a multi-tenant PostgreSQL instance with Row-Level Security (RLS) on PgBouncer connection poolers.²⁹
- Run automated load tests simulating 1,000 concurrent transactions to verify that transaction-scoped variables prevent data leakage.²⁹
- Measure HNSW index build times and query latencies under transactional write load.³¹

Phase 4: Edge Model Profiling and Client Latency Optimization (Weeks 7-8)

- Measure Gemma-3-4B and Qwen-3B execution speeds across multiple mobile chipsets (Android NNAPI / iOS CoreML).²³
- Profile CPU and battery consumption during local summarization and entity extraction tasks.²³
- Tune React Query configurations to prevent background zombie queries from leaking memory on active Expo stacks.¹⁵

Phase 5: DPDP Compliance Audit and Architecture Verification (Weeks 9-10)

- Implement localized consent collection forms in English, Hindi, and regional languages.²
- Verify that consent withdrawal actions trigger automated data deletion across all

databases.⁵⁴

- Complete a comprehensive security audit of the sovereign Indian cloud deployment, ensuring that data encryption keys are securely isolated.⁵⁸

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